WHAT WE BUILT

An AI assistant for force enrollment

Students ask in plain English. The assistant checks the rules, asks the right people to approve, and completes the request.

People

S

Student
asks for a seat in a full course

I

Instructor
approves or rejects the request

through a web app or the terminal

The assistant

- Understands the request
- Plans the steps it will take
- Checks every rule, using a helper agent
- Asks the student, then the instructor, to approve
- Enrolls the student and remembers the outcome

University records

A practice copy of Zambeel: students, courses, sections and enrollments.

A full history of every request and every change.

synthetic data only

Outside services we use

Databricks
the AI model (gpt-oss-120b)

LangSmith
watching what the AI does

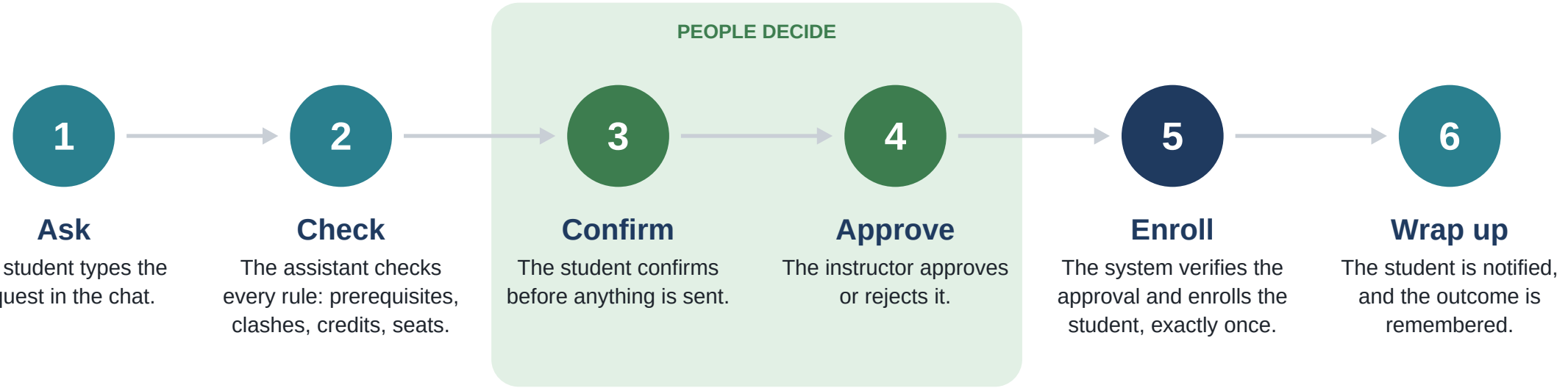
GitHub
our code

Claude Design
designed the web app

HOW IT WORKS

One request, start to finish

Example: a student asks *“Can I get force enrolled in CS412?”*



If something goes wrong, nothing unsafe happens

Not eligible
The assistant explains why. No request is created.

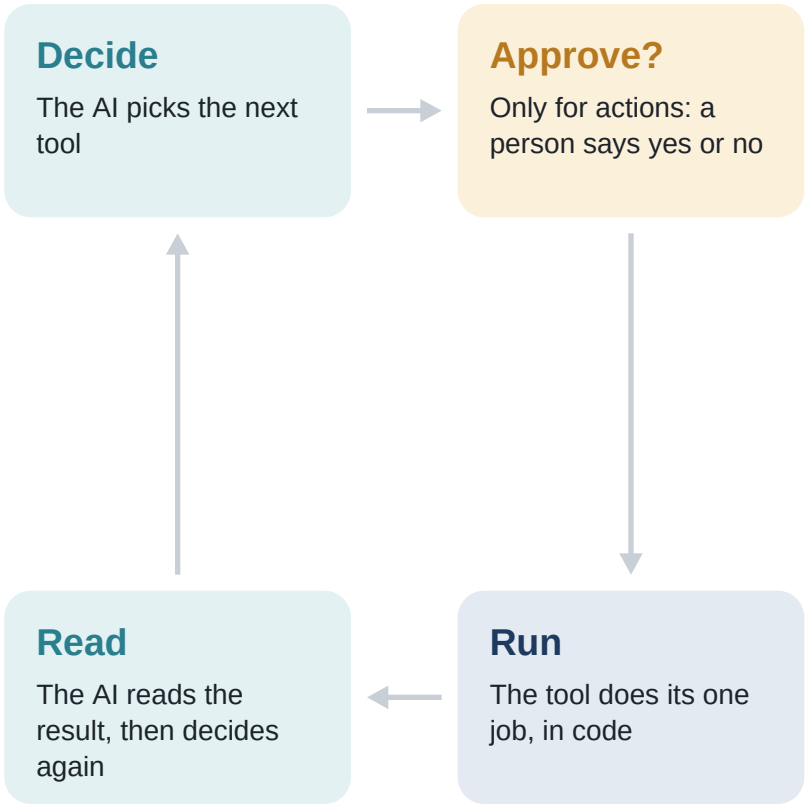
Declined or rejected
The request is closed. Nothing changes.

Seat filled in the meantime
The system stops safely. No over-enrollment.

TOOL CALLING

How the assistant uses tools

The AI decides what to do next. Each tool does one job, and the risky ones need a person’s approval first.



Look things up

my profile · my requests · the course catalogue

Check the rules

one section · every course this term · ask the student a question

done by a separate helper agent that can only read

Take action, with approval

send the request · enroll · notify the student · save a note

Built-in safety: the AI can never choose whose data it sees, and only the main assistant can take action.

KEY DECISIONS

What we chose, and why

Each decision is written up with its reasons and the alternatives in our design log.

1 Safety lives in code

Approvals use signed, single-use passes that the AI itself cannot create.

2 People stay in control

Nothing is sent without the student, and nothing is enrolled without the instructor.

3 Checked three times

Eligibility is checked again when the request is made, submitted and carried out.

4 Nothing gets lost

Requests survive a restart, and every change is logged.

5 A helper agent for checks

A separate checker keeps the main assistant focused, and it can only read.

6 A free, swappable AI model

gpt-oss-120b on Databricks Free Edition. The model is a setting, not code.

M0–M9
milestones complete

218
automated tests passing

50
course sections to test with

2
human approvals per request